THE CLIENT SERVICE BENCHMARK · 2026

This is what elite client service looks like.

A first-of-its-kind benchmark drawn from **1M+ calls**, **10M+ emails** and **thousands of chat messages** - all anonymised - comparing the activity of client service professionals with clients where relationships grow versus the ones that slip away.

VOL. 01
MAY 2026

HOW WE RAN THE BENCHMARK

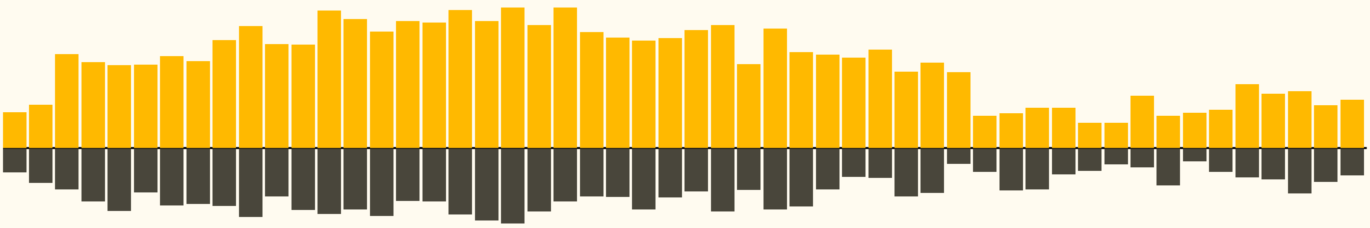
The Best vs The Rest.

Two cohorts: Clients where CSAT and revenue grew and clients where CSAT and revenue declined.

For twelve months we watched what happens inside the relationships that win - and the ones that quietly slip away. Across millions of anonymised conversations - calls, emails, chat messages - the same instrumented analysis was run across top and bottom client portfolios. No names. Just the work.

THE DATASET

1M+	10M+	'000s
CALLS ANALYSED	EMAILS CATEGORISED	CHAT MESSAGES PARSED



BEST VS THE REST

PART ONE · EIGHT FINDINGS

What you need to know

Eight findings, in order. Each one is coachable on its own - and together they trace the through-line: top and bottom accounts differ in *volume, frequency and who's in the room*, not in shape.

01 Conversation Mix

Top and bottom accounts talk about almost the same things. Deltas within ±2 pts. But not everything!

02 Two Coachable Markers

Goals talk and market intel - the two behaviours that cleanly separate top from bottom.

03 Decision-Maker Engagement

DMs show up roughly twice as often on top accounts.

04 The Ideal AM Activity

Same portfolio, same ratios - 1.84× the activity. A cadence, not a style.

05 Stakeholder Coverage

You guessed it, more stakeholder coverage wins!

06 Doomsday

~38% of struggling accounts surface their own warning signs. The shape of trouble.

07 The Risk Paradox

Top accounts surface 2.2× more risks, not fewer. Challenging honest conversations are good in partnerships.

08 The AM Power Law

AMs on top accounts are having a lot more client interactions. Plan for the distribution.

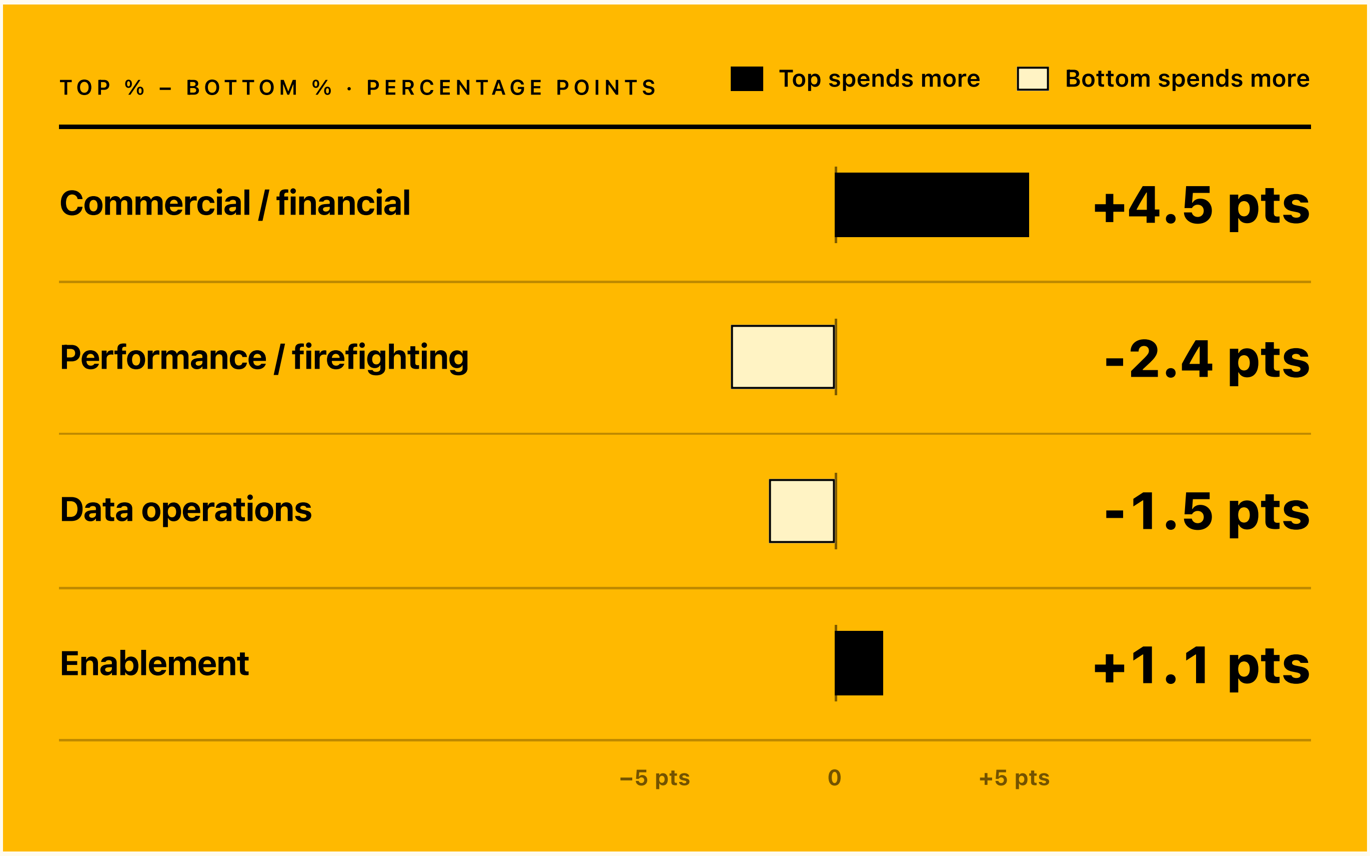
The through-line: volume, not shape. Top and bottom accounts look remarkably similar in *what* they do - they differ in how much, how often, and with whom.

01

CONVERSATION MIX

Top accounts aren't afraid to talk about money!

The category mix is the differentiator we expected and didn't find. Every delta below the chart is within ±5 percentage points - and most are within ±2. But the willingness to ask for money stands out



THE TAKE

The differentiator isn't *subject matter* - it's volume, depth, and who's in the room. The other findings in this report do the work of explaining what those three actually look like.

02

TWO COACHABLE MARKERS

Two markers you can coach now.

The two behaviours where top and bottom differ in *kind* rather than just degree - and both are answerable with a yes-or-no question at the call level.

MARKER · 01

Goals talk

Share of categorised interactions that name the client's stated goals.

SHARE OF INTERACTIONS

1.43×

MORE OFTEN ON TOP ACCOUNTS

ASK IN YOUR NEXT 1:1

"Did the last call name a specific client goal?"

MARKER · 02

Market intelligence

Share that references competitor moves, sector trends, or external context.

SHARE OF REFERENCES

20×

MORE OFTEN ON TOP ACCOUNTS

ASK IN YOUR NEXT 1:1

"Did you bring something the client didn't already know?"

THE TAKE

Two questions for every AM's weekly review: which client objective did you name, and what did you bring into the conversation about the client's market?

03

DECISION-MAKER ENGAGEMENT

DMs show up roughly twice as often on top accounts.

The cleanest finding in the report. The gap isn't in *which* decision-makers are engaged - both cohorts engage about half of the DMs they've defined. The gap is in **how often**.

1.81×	**2.06×**	**1.41×**	**~1.0×**
DM CALLS / ACCOUNT / MONTH	DM EMAILS / ACCOUNT / MONTH	DM TALK-TIME SHARE WHEN PRESENT	DM ENGAGEMENT RATE (ENGAGED ÷ DEFINED)
1.67 vs 0.92	**45.7** vs 22.1	**16.3%** vs 11.5%	**52.7%** vs 50.0%

WHAT THE DATA SAYS

Both cohorts engage about half of their defined decision-makers. Top accounts simply engage the same DMs **twice as often**. ***Frequency, as important as breadth, separates the two.***

04 THE IDEAL ACCOUNT MANAGER

Identical portfolio. Identical ratios. 1.84× the coverage.

Across the active AMs in the dataset, top-cohort managers don't operate differently - they operate *more*. The ideal AM profile is not a style. It is a cadence.

METRIC	TOP	BOTTOM	RATIO	WHAT IT MEANS
# clients interacted with	23.1	22.9	~1.0×	Identical portfolio's - same role on paper.
Email-to-call ratio	19.5	19.4	~1.0×	Identical channel mix.
AM talk-time share	13.2%	13.9%	~1.0×	Identical air-time on calls.
Calls per AM / year	24.9	13.5	1.84×	Almost twice the call cadence.
Emails per AM / year	342	232	1.47×	Half again the email volume.

THE TAKE

Top performing Clients get more coverage. Craft a team that covers clients proactively - and reward the AMs already producing it.

05 STAKEHOLDER COVERAGE

Top relationships are bigger, not differently shaped.

More people on both sides of the table. More inbound. **The team-to-client headcount ratio holds exactly** - coverage scales together, not separately.

CLIENT-TO-TEAM HEADCOUNT RATIO

1 : 9.12

TOP COHORT

BOTTOM COHORT

The cleanest finding on this page. Both cohorts run roughly nine client contacts for every one of their own - same shape, every time. The differences are about **scale**, not **structure**.

WHERE THE SCALE SHOWS UP · TOP VS. BOTTOM

		TOP	BOTTOM
Client stakeholders engaged	1.71×	242	142
Internal contacts on the account	1.45×	21.4	14.7
Client-initiated email threads	2.91×	541	186

THE TAKE

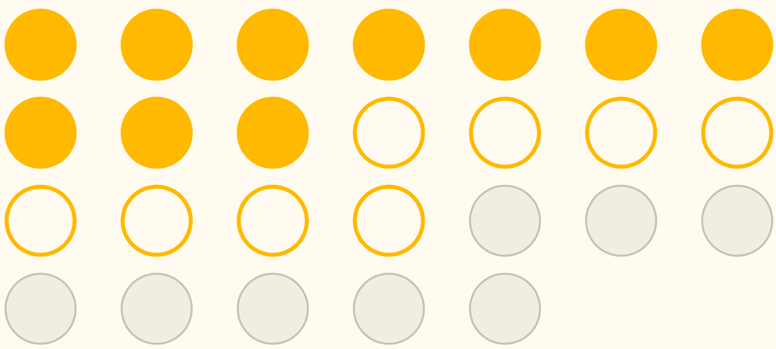
Don't restructure the relationship - grow it. The cohorts differ in volume, not in who initiates or who owns.

06 THE SHAPE OF AN ACCOUNT IN TROUBLE

Struggling accounts aren't silent. They're already telling you.

Across the bottom cohort, more than two in three accounts surfaced at least one risk phrase in conversation. Four in ten did so repeatedly. The signal is sitting in the call transcript already.

BOTTOM-COHORT ACCOUNTS · RISK SIGNAL STATUS



10 / 26
Risks recurred across periods

8 / 26
Surfaced at least once

8 / 26
No surfaced risk signal

~69%
of struggling accounts surface their own warning signs

187 Total risk phrases logged across the cohort	**10 / 26** Accounts where risks recurred across periods	**>7 AI CSAT** CSAT for the cohort - "satisfied but not delighted, even in trouble"

THE TAKE

The shape of an account in trouble isn't quiet. It is talking about its problems out loud. The question is whether anyone is listening - and whether the same theme returning is being treated as a signal, or as noise.

07

THE RISK PARADOX

Top accounts surface 2.2× more risks - not fewer.

Most CS dashboards read low risk counts as a positive signal. The data says the opposite. **A quiet risk register on an active account is a warning sign, not a green light.**

2.21×

RISK PHRASES LOGGED · PER ACCOUNT · PER YEAR

Top-cohort relationships have richer conversation surface area for risks to emerge - and top-cohort AMs are more diligent at recording them.

1.29×

RECURRING RISK CLUSTERS · PER ACCOUNT

When risks surface in the top cohort, they tend to be returned to and resolved. Recurrence is the signature of sustained engagement, not failure.

THE TAKE

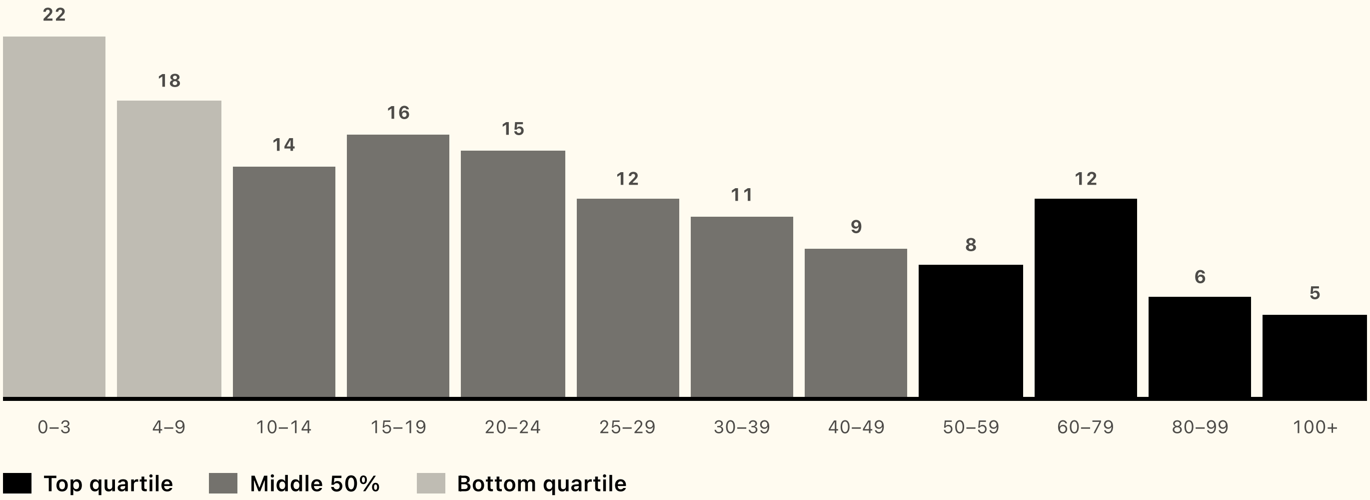
Sort your at-risk dashboard by the absence of risk activity, not by its presence. The silent ones are the dangerous ones.

08 THE AM POWER LAW

AMs do two-thirds more comms on Clients that grow.

The variance *inside* the AM role dwarfs the variance between top and bottom cohorts. The same role, the same nominal portfolio - and a 21× activity gap from the top quartile to the bottom.

ACCOUNT MANAGERS RANKED BY CALL VOLUME · CALLS PER YEAR



64 MEAN CALLS / YR · TOP QUARTILE vs 3 · bottom quartile	**908** MEAN EMAILS / YR · TOP QUARTILE vs 63 · bottom quartile	**66.2%** OF ALL CUSTOMER CALLS, MADE BY TOP QUARTILE the top quartile	**~21×** ACTIVITY GAP · TOP VS. BOTTOM QUARTILE same role, same portfolio

THE TAKE

Plan for the distribution, not the average. **Losing one top-quartile AM is operationally equivalent to losing seven median ones.** The hiring profile should be predictive of throughput.

PART TWO · CARE FRAMEWORK BENCHMARKS

Four pillars. Sixteen verified metrics. Welcome to CARE.

WHAT IS CARE?

CARE is Kaizan's framework for client relationship health - a structured, multidimensional view of where every account stands across **four pillars** (Client Satisfaction · Activity · Relationship Quality · Expansion). The sixteen metrics on the next page are the ones with defensible numbers in this edition.

C

Client Satisfaction

How the client actually feels - and how often we bother to measure.

A

Activity with Stakeholders

Whether the right people are engaged, often enough.

R

Relationship & Interaction Quality

Whether interactions are deepening - or quietly becoming transactional.

E

Expansion

Whether the conditions are right to grow - and whether the team is acting on them.

How to read it. Strength in one pillar doesn't compensate for weakness in another. They're tracked independently so you can see exactly where to focus next.

SIXTEEN VERIFIED METRICS · TOP COHORT VS. BOTTOM COHORT

C · A · R · E

The benchmark, in full.

Read this carefully on C: where CSAT is actually measured, top and bottom score identically (7.1 / 7.1). The headline CSAT gap most reports cite is a **measurement-frequency gap**, not a satisfaction gap. The first action to move CSAT is not to move it - it is to measure it.

PILLAR 01

Client Satisfaction

C

METRIC	TOP VS BOT	TOP
CSAT (where measured)		7.1 vs 7.1
CSAT measurements per year		41 vs 14
Goals-conversation share		11.2% vs 7.8%
Market-intelligence share		0.35% vs 0.02%

PILLAR 02

Activity with Stakeholders

A

METRIC	TOP VS BOT	TOP
Calls per month (per account)		5.8 vs 2.3
DM calls per month		1.67 vs 0.92
Client stakeholders engaged		242 vs 142
DM talk-time share		16.3% vs 11.5%

PILLAR 03

Relationship & Interaction Quality

R

METRIC	TOP VS BOT	TOP
Client talk-time share		65% vs 61%
High/Low Moments surfaced per call		4.05 vs 3.29
Risks surfaced per year		15.3 vs 6.9
Risk clusters per period		1.96 vs 1.52

PILLAR 04

Expansion

E

METRIC	TOP VS BOT	TOP
Commercial moments per year		265 vs 105
High-value moment share		54% vs 43%
New-business conversation share		1.66% vs 1.03%
Commercial / financial conv. share		12.9% vs 8.3%

FROM THE EIGHT FINDINGS · TWENTY-FOUR PRACTICAL MOVES

Eight findings. Three moves each. Start Monday.

01 CONVERSATION MIX **Same subjects. More depth, more often.**	**Audit a sample of calls.** Tag interactions by category for the last month. The mix won't look that different from the bottom - that's the point. You need to dive deeper into what causes conversations about expansion.	**Concentrate the deltas.** Top accounts skew slightly higher on commercial / financial and enablement. Build agenda templates for top accounts that pre-allocate time to both.	**AI-drafted outside-in.** For every top account, every month, generate an account-specific POV - market scan, competitor angle, regulatory move. Provide before the client asks.
02 COACHABLE MARKERS **Two questions, every week.**	**Add to the weekly 1:1.** Which client objectives did you discuss on a call this week? What did you bring from outside the room about their market?	**Score calls on goal-naming.** Tag every call with whether a client goal was named. Top cohort hits 11.2%; aim there.	**Build the outside-in muscle.** Equip every AM with a weekly digest of competitor, sector, and regulatory moves relevant to their accounts. Lower the cost of bringing something new.
03 DM ENGAGEMENT **Same DMs, twice the frequency.**	**Set a DM-touch target.** Target ≥2 DM calls per month per top account. Track it weekly. Both cohorts engage half their DMs; only frequency separates them.	**Send a 48h DM prep brief.** Three questions, one POV, one ask. Walk the DM in already thinking, so they speak when they arrive instead of nodding through.	**Pre-call alignment with the AM.** Fifteen minutes the day before: who is the DM, what do they care about, what one question do we want them to answer out loud.
04 THE IDEAL AM **Throughput, not style.**	**Promote on cadence.** Top AMs run more interactions with clients. Simple. Benchmark how much time your team is spending with clients.	**Protect the high-throughput AMs.** Don't reward heavy hitters with more accounts - reward with fewer, harder ones. The same role at higher cadence is the win condition.	**Hire for throughput predictors.** Stop screening for "style." Screen for energy, follow-through, and reply-time discipline. The behavioural data points to cadence as the differentiator.
05 STAKEHOLDER COVERAGE **Engineer scale, not new shape.**	**Set a "new contact / month" target.** Each AM introduces one new client-side stakeholder per top account, per month.	**Pair every key account with a sponsor.** A senior internal sponsor owns one quarterly conversation with the client lead. Bring leadership in by default, not by escalation.	**Watch the ratio, not the count.** The 9.12× client-to-AM headcount ratio is identical across cohorts. Don't over-staff - over-engage.
06 SHAPE OF TROUBLE **Listen for what they're already saying.**	**Weekly risk-phrase scan.** Surface the top recurring risk phrases from last week's calls and emails to the AM in a Monday digest.	**Flag recurrence, not first mention.** ~38% of bottom-cohort accounts surface their warning signs. The signature is the same theme returning. Treat repetition as the signal.	**Don't wait for CSAT to move.** CSAT for the bottom cohort sits at < 7 - satisfied but not delighted. The score won't warn you. The conversation already has.
07 THE RISK PARADOX **Resort your risk dashboard.**	**Sort by absence of risk activity.** A quiet risk register on an active account is a warning sign, not a green light. Build a "silent on risk" view and review it weekly.	**Reward AMs who log risks.** Top-cohort AMs log 2.2× more risks. Treat risk-logging as a positive performance signal, not a complaint. More comms and more challenging = more risk terminolgy	**Audit your at-risk top 10.** For each account currently flagged at-risk, count logged risks in the last 90 days. The dangerous accounts are the more silent ones.
08 THE AM POWER LAW **Plan for the distribution.**	**Clear the path to more client time.** Map where time goes today. Strip out the internal noise blocking conversations. More room = more output.	**Build a retention plan for the top quartile.** Losing one is equivalent to losing seven median AMs. Comp, ownership, sponsorship, air cover - back the people driving the curve	**Coach toward the median, not the mean.** "Team average" is a fiction shaped by heavy hitters. Build development plans against the median, and pair them with top performers.

TO CLOSE

"The recipe for a top-cohort client is becoming clear. A systematic cadence is key: prioritise interactions, with the right person, on the market and opportunities, often so you can't be ignored."

This is the first of many insights from Kaizan HQ — diving deep into client relationship management and delivery in the AI era, to help you drive more ROI, satisfaction and revenue from your client portfolio.

METHODOLOGY

Anonymised by design.

Sample. Millions of interactions - over 1M calls, 10M emails and thousands of chat messages - analysed across top and bottom client portfolios over a twelve-month period.

Anonymisation. Every figure is aggregated at the cohort level. No individual client portfolio, team or person is named or identifiable.

Cohort definition. Top and bottom client portfolios are nominated by clients with greatest CSAT and Revenue vs lowest.

What's not here. Sentiment trajectories, CSAT-recovery time, themes-resolved-per-quarter, trust-recovery time, commitment completion rates, and active-listening signals. Future editions will fill them in.

NEXT STEP

Get your CARE score.

Benchmark your own client portfolio against this aggregated, anonymised global dataset every month - same metrics, same cohorts, your own clients.

Book a demo at kaizan.ai →

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